



Feature Documentation

NONPARTISAN POLITICAL & VOTER INFORMATION APP

Version 1.0 (Build 8) • July 2026 • Live on the App Store

Platforms: iOS (App Store) & Android (Google Play rollout in progress), Web preview

Application Overview

UDecide is a mobile app that helps U.S. voters understand their government and participate in elections. It brings together a citizen's elected representatives, upcoming elections, active legislation, voter registration tools, and civic education — all presented from a strictly nonpartisan standpoint. The app never ranks parties, endorses candidates, or editorializes.

How it works

Everything in the app is driven by the user's location. After creating an account, the user provides their address; the app then tailors representatives, elections, and legislation to their federal, state, county, and city jurisdictions. A location override lets users explore any other U.S. address without changing their profile.

Technology at a glance

Layer	Description
Mobile app	Expo / React Native (iOS & Android), with a web preview build. Five-tab navigation with a native "liquid glass" tab bar on modern iOS.
API server	A Node.js (Express) backend that securely brokers sign-in, profile, representative, news, and AI fact-check requests, keeping those service credentials (such as the Cicero and Gemini keys) on the server rather than on the device. Hosted in production on Render at <code>udecide-api.onrender.com</code> , deployed automatically from GitHub.
Data sources	Legacy UDecide member system (accounts, polls, questionnaires, news), Cicero (elected officials by address), Google Civic Information API (live elections), LegiScan (state legislation), Congress.gov (federal data), Google Gemini (AI fact-checking).
Sign-in options	Email & password. (Sign in with Google is built and server-verified but disabled in the 1.0 release; it returns in a future update alongside Sign in with Apple.)

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Screenshots in this document were captured from the live application (web preview build) using a demo account. Native iOS/Android rendering is visually equivalent with platform-native fonts, safe areas, and tab bar treatments.

Account & Sign-in

Sign In

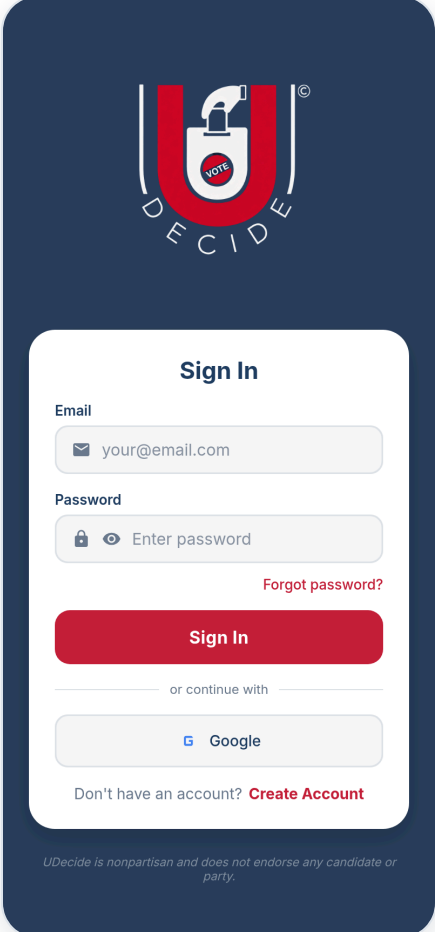
- Email + password sign-in against the UDecide member system.
- Password visibility toggle and inline validation with clear error messages.
- Sessions persist securely on the device; users stay signed in between launches.
- **Sign in with Google** (currently disabled): the full server-verified flow is implemented — Google confirms the identity on the server, so the app can never forge an account, and new users finish with a short city + ZIP step. The button is hidden in the 1.0 store release and will be re-enabled in a future update together with Sign in with Apple.

Create Account

- Collects name, email, password, and location (city, state, ZIP).
- Validation on every field before submission.
- After registration, a profile-setup step captures the full street address that powers representative and election matching.

Forgot Password

- Self-service reset: the user enters their account email and receives reset instructions.



The image shows a mobile app screen for signing in. At the top is the UDecide logo, which features a red 'U' with a white ballot box and a red 'VOTE' button inside it, with the word 'DECIDE' in white below it. The screen has a dark blue background. A white card in the center contains the 'Sign In' form. The form has two input fields: 'Email' with a placeholder 'your@email.com' and 'Password' with a placeholder 'Enter password'. There is a red 'Forgot password?' link next to the password field. Below the fields is a red 'Sign In' button. Underneath the button is a link 'or continue with' followed by a Google logo and the text 'Google'. At the bottom of the card is a link 'Don't have an account? Create Account'. At the very bottom of the screen, in small text, it says 'UDecide is nonpartisan and does not endorse any candidate or party.'

Sign In screen





Create Account

Join UDecide to access voter tools and political information

First Name

 Jane

Last Name

 Smith

Email

 your@email.com

Password

 Min. 8 characters 

Confirm Password

 Re-enter password

City

 Your city

ZIP Code

 12345

Create Account

Registration flow

Account creation runs through the secure API server to the UDecide member system. Duplicate emails and invalid entries return friendly, actionable messages. All traffic between the app and the API server is encrypted (HTTPS).



Reset Password

Enter your email and we'll send instructions to reset your password.

Email Address

 your@email.com

Send Reset Instructions

Back to Sign In

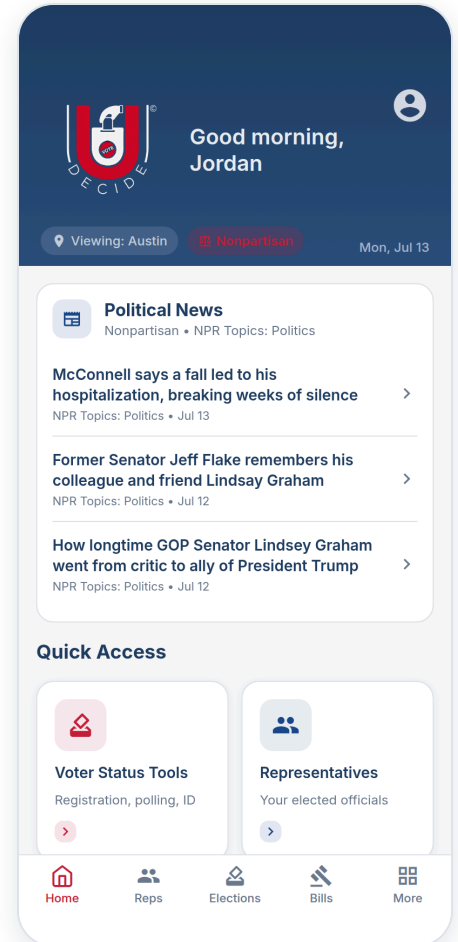
Forgot Password

Dashboard (Home)

The dashboard is the user's civic home base — a card-driven layout that surfaces the most relevant information and provides one-tap access to every feature.

- Personalized greeting and the user's current civic location.
- Quick-access cards to Representatives, Elections, Legislation, Voter Tools, Polls, Fact Checker, and more.
- Political news access via the member news feed, opened as readable in-app articles.
- Reference links (state/town resources) supplied by the member system.
- Nonpartisanship notice reinforcing the app's neutral stance.

All personalized content follows the user's **effective location** — their profile address, or the temporary override set in Location Override (Section 12).

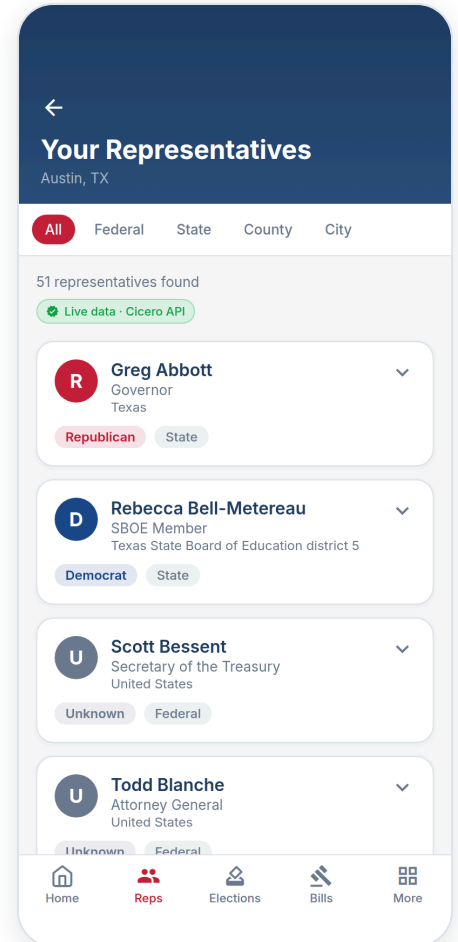


Dashboard

Representatives

See every elected official who represents you — from the President down to city council — based on your exact address.

- Officials grouped by level: **Federal, State, County, City** with an easy filter row.
- Live data from the Cicero civic-data service, requested securely through the API server.
- Each official shows their photo, office, party affiliation, and contact channels (phone, email, website, social).
- Detail view includes term information and, where available, voting-record context.
- Updates automatically when the user's effective location changes.

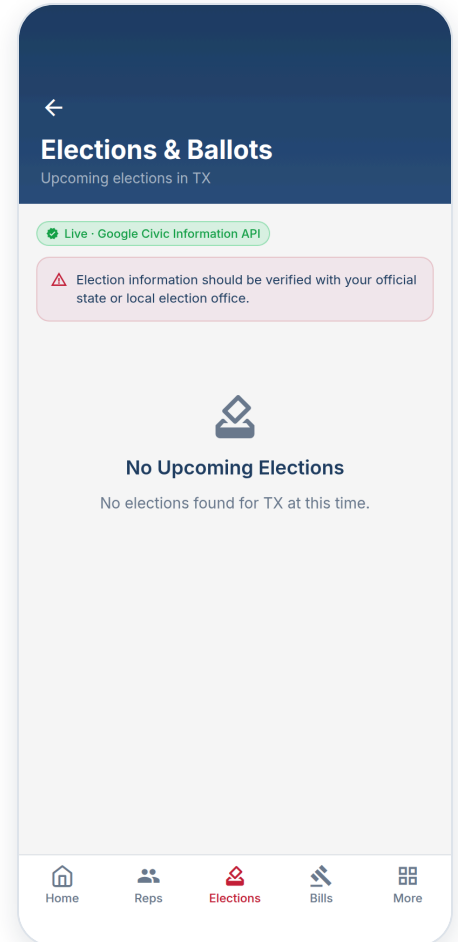


Representatives tab

Elections & Ballots

A forward-looking view of every election that affects the user, with the practical details needed to participate.

- Upcoming federal, state, and local elections for the user's jurisdictions.
- Key dates: election day, registration deadlines, early-voting windows, and absentee deadlines.
- Candidate listings presented neutrally — no endorsements or rankings.
- Countdown context so users know how soon each election is.

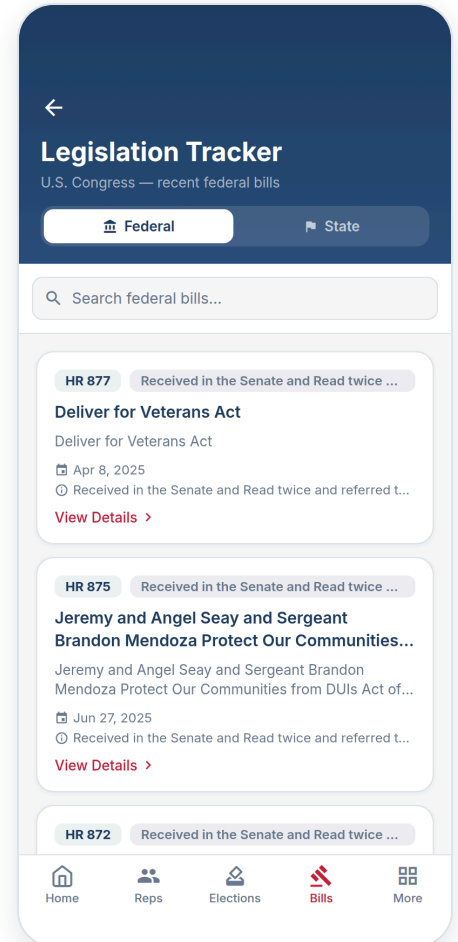


Elections tab

Legislation Tracker

Follow bills as they move through the user's state legislature and Congress.

- State legislation from the LegiScan service; federal data from Congress.gov.
- Bill cards show number, title, plain-language status (Introduced, In Committee, Passed, Signed, etc.), and last action.
- Search and filtering to find bills by topic.
- Detail view summarizes the bill and its progress timeline.

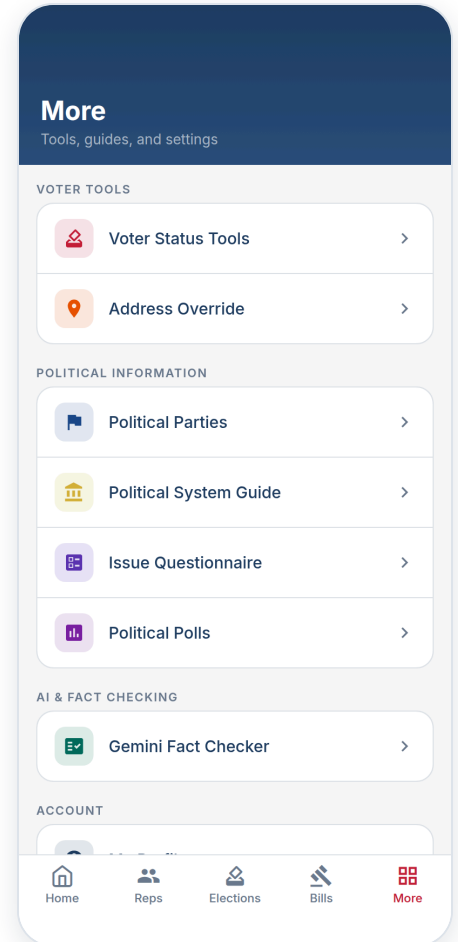


Legislation tab

More Menu

The fifth tab collects the app's remaining tools and account controls in one organized menu.

- Voter Tools, Political Parties, Political System Guide, Civics Quiz, Polls, Issue Questionnaire, and the AI Fact Checker.
- Profile management and Location Override.
- Static informational pages (about, terms, privacy) provided by the member system.
- Sign out.

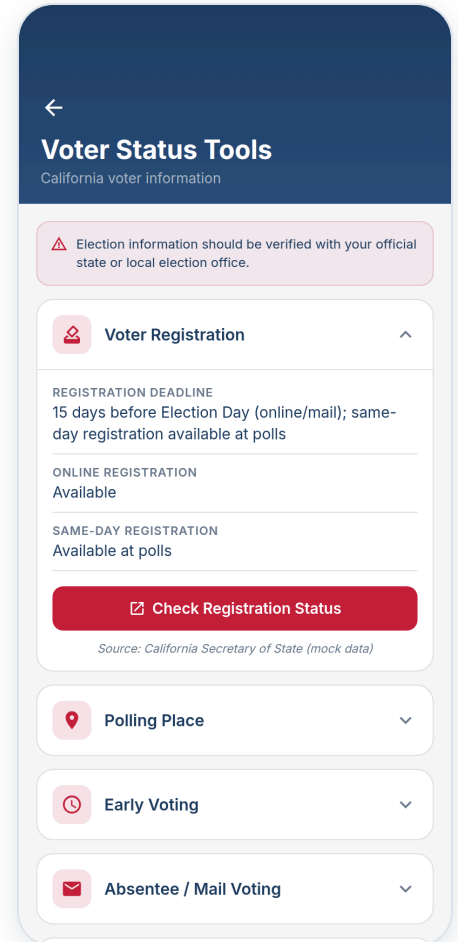


More tab

Voter Tools

Practical, state-aware guidance that turns intent into a cast ballot.

- Voter-registration status guidance and links to official state registration resources.
- Polling-place information for the user's address.
- Absentee / mail-in voting rules and deadlines for the user's state.
- Early-voting availability and windows.
- ID requirements and what to bring on election day.

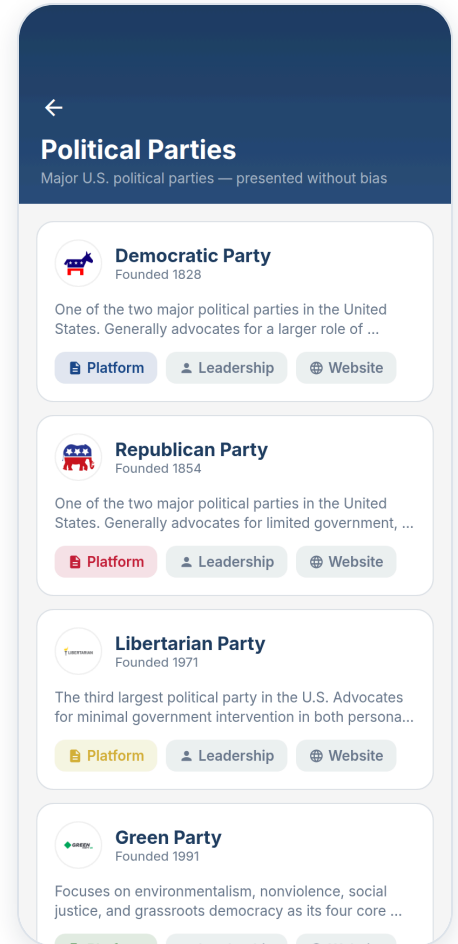


Voter Tools

Political Parties

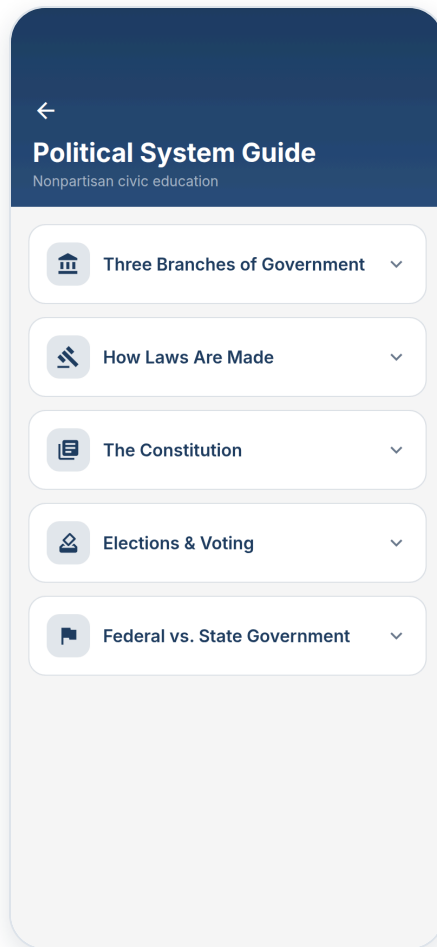
A balanced reference on America's political parties.

- Profiles of the major and notable minor parties.
- Neutral platform summaries — history, core positions, and organization.
- Identical presentation for every party: no ordering by preference, no rankings, no commentary.



Political Parties

Political System Guide & Civics Quiz



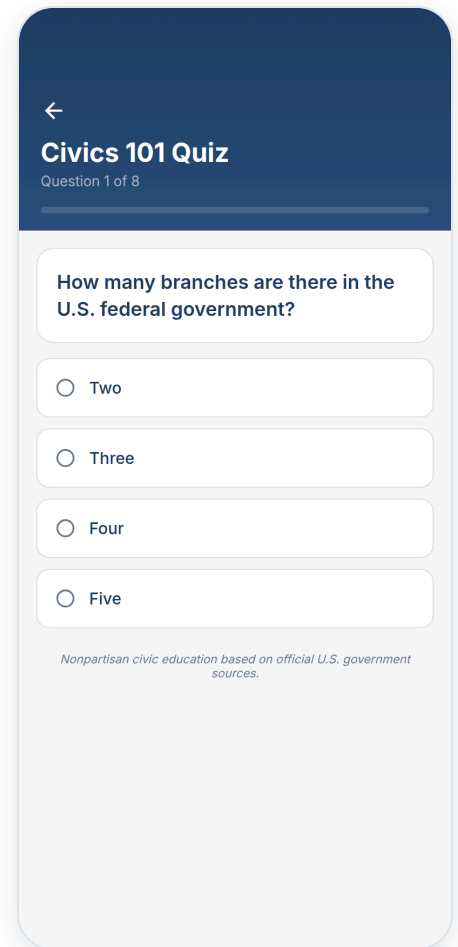
Political System Guide

Political System Guide

- Civic-education explainers: the three branches of government, how a bill becomes law, the Constitution and amendments, and how elections work.
- Written in plain language for readers of any background.

Civics Quiz

- An interactive quiz that lets users test their civic knowledge.
- Instant feedback per question and a score summary at the end.



Civics Quiz

Polls & Issue Questionnaires

←

Political Polls

Community perspectives — not scientific unless stated

All Economy Healthcare Immigration Education

Civic Engagement 787 votes

How important is increasing voter turnout in your community?

Critically important

Somewhat important

Neutral

Not important

Tap an option to vote

Community poll — results reflect app users and are not a scientific sample.

Local Issues 1.0K votes

Which local issue matters most to you this year?

Education

Infrastructure & roads

Community Polls

Community Polls

- Members vote on current civic questions from the UDecide community.
- One vote per member per poll; results are viewable after voting.
- Live results with vote counts and percentages.

Issue Questionnaires

- Structured issue sets that let users record where they stand on policy topics.
- Stances are private to the user — an informational self-assessment, not a public poll.

←

Issue Questionnaire

Explore where you stand on the issues

Education Issues Environmental Issues Economic Issues

QUESTION 1

Do you support increasing taxes for the rich in order to reduce interest rates for student loans?

☐ No, and transition all current government student loans into privately managed accounts

☐ No, but we should still reduce interest rates for student loans

☐ Yes, and increase government funding so every student receives a free college education

☐ No

☐ Yes

QUESTION 2

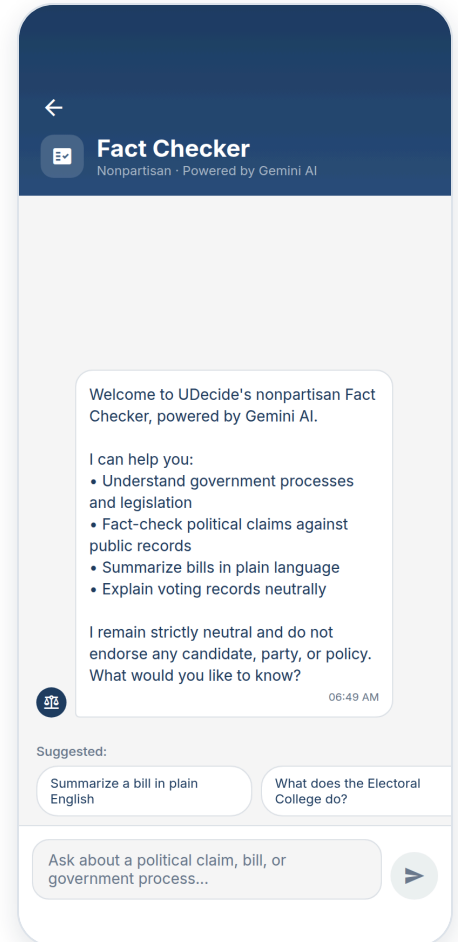
Should the federal government pay for tuition at four-year colleges and universities?

Issue Questionnaire

AI Fact Checker

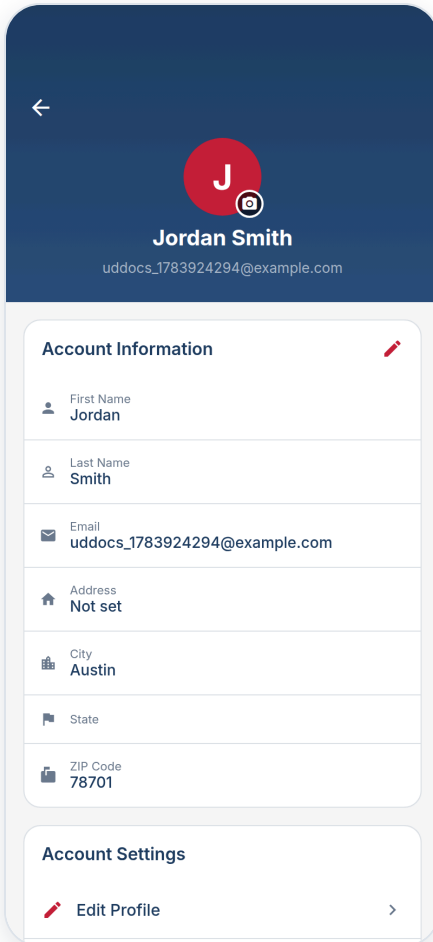
A conversational assistant, powered by Google's Gemini AI, purpose-built for neutral political fact-checking.

- Users paste a claim or ask a question; the assistant responds with factual, sourced-style context.
- A strict nonpartisan system prompt keeps answers neutral — the assistant describes, it never advocates.
- Streaming, chat-style interface with conversation history during the session.
- **Usage limit:** 10 questions per session in the app, enforced again on the server (10 requests per 15 minutes per account) to control AI costs and prevent abuse — even direct API calls cannot bypass it.
- All AI requests are proxied through the UDecide API server; the Gemini credential never ships inside the app.
- Clear disclaimer that AI answers are informational and users should verify with primary sources.



AI Fact Checker

Profile & Location Override



The Profile screen features a dark blue header with a back arrow, a red circular profile icon with a white 'J', and the name 'Jordan Smith' with the email 'uddocs_1783924294@example.com'. Below the header is a white card titled 'Account Information' with a red edit icon. It contains fields for First Name (Jordan), Last Name (Smith), Email (uddocs_1783924294@example.com), Address (Not set), City (Austin), State, and ZIP Code (78701). At the bottom is another white card titled 'Account Settings' with an 'Edit Profile' button and a right arrow.

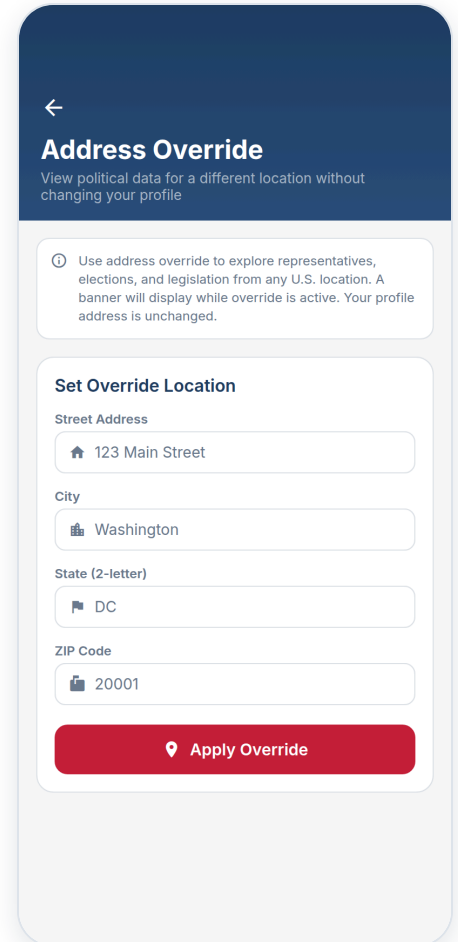
Profile

Profile

- Edit name, contact details, and the home address that drives all location-based features.
- Profile photo upload from the device photo library.
- Changes save to the UDecide member system and take effect across the app immediately.

Location Override

- Explore the political landscape of **any U.S. address** — representatives, elections, and legislation for that location — without changing the saved profile.
- A visible indicator shows when an override is active; one tap returns to the home address.



The Address Override screen has a dark blue header with a back arrow and the title 'Address Override'. Below the header is a light gray box with an information icon and text: 'Use address override to explore representatives, elections, and legislation from any U.S. location. A banner will display while override is active. Your profile address is unchanged.' Below this is a white card titled 'Set Override Location' with input fields for Street Address (123 Main Street), City (Washington), State (2-letter) (DC), and ZIP Code (20001). At the bottom is a red button with a location pin icon and the text 'Apply Override'.

Location Override

PART 2

Developer Guide

Architecture, production hosting on Render, codebase setup, environment configuration, build & release, and known issues for engineers.

App v1.0 (Build 8) — Live on the App Store • Guide v1.1 — July 2026
Backend: udecide-api.onrender.com (Render) • Internal / Confidential

Repository Layout (pnpm monorepo)

The repo root is a pnpm workspace (`pnpm-workspace.yaml` ; `packages:` `artifacts/*` , `lib/*` , `lib/integrations/*` , `scripts`). Uses `catalog:` for shared dependency versions and a `minimumReleaseAge` supply-chain guard — do not disable.

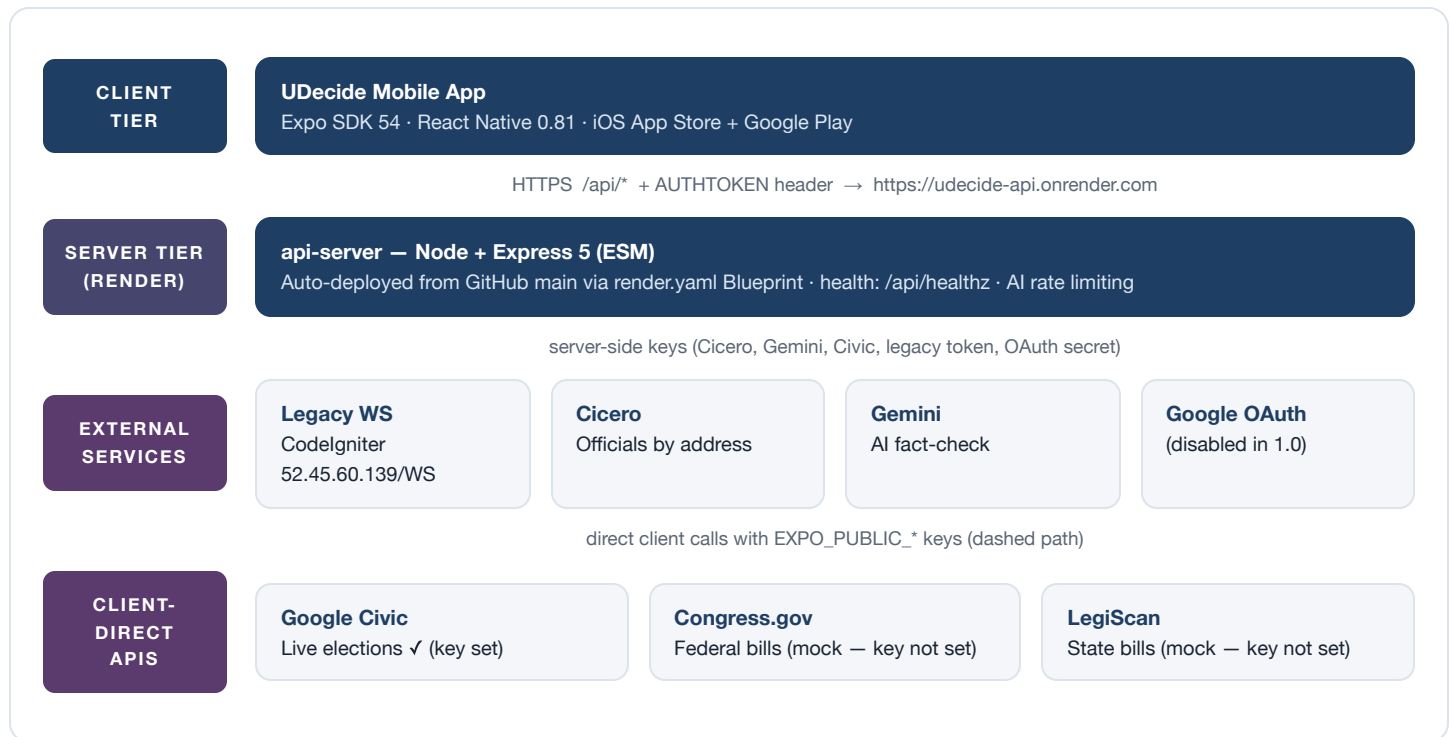
```
Udecide-Mobile-App/
├─ artifacts/
│  ├─ udecide/          # THE MOBILE APP (Expo / React Native) – @workspace/udecide
│  ├─ api-server/       # THE BACKEND (Node/Express proxy) – @workspace/api-server
│  └─ mockup-sandbox/   # design/mockup sandbox (not shipped)
├─ lib/                 # shared workspace packages (api-spec/openapi.yaml, api-zod, ...)
├─ render.yaml          # Render Blueprint – production deploy of api-server (Section 3)
├─ eas.json             # (root, STALE) – active config is artifacts/udecide/eas.json
├─ mobile/              # blank Expo template – NOT the product (ignore)
└─ pnpm-workspace.yaml
```

Warning: Two decoy directories: `mobile/` is an empty Expo starter, and the root `eas.json` is stale. The real app is `artifacts/udecide/` and the real EAS config is `artifacts/udecide/eas.json` . Run all `eas/expo` commands from `artifacts/udecide/` .

Install everything from the repo root: `pnpm install` . GitHub: `tommphefferson-source/Udecide-Mobile-App` (branch `main` ; pushes auto-deploy the backend, see Section 3).

Architecture Overview

Three tiers. The mobile app never talks to the database or paid APIs directly for sensitive paths — the api-server (hosted on **Render**) proxies them so keys stay server-side.



Two request families in services/

- **API-server-proxied** (auth, representatives, quiz, news, polls, questionnaires, fact-check, pages) — go to https://udecide-api.onrender.com/api with the custom AUTHTOKEN header. Real upstream keys live on the server.
- **Direct-to-external** (electionsApi, congressApi, legiscanApi) — call third-party APIs from the client with an EXPO_PUBLIC_* key and fall back to bundled mock data when the key is missing. Elections is live (key baked in since build 11); Congress/LegiScan still serve samples.

Auth model

The legacy backend uses a custom AUTHTOKEN header (NOT Authorization: Bearer). Login/signup return an auth_token; the app stores it and the api-server forwards it upstream. A 401 anywhere clears the session and returns the user to login.

Sign in with Google is fully implemented (server-verified OAuth) but **hidden in the 1.0 release** behind SHOW_GOOGLE_SIGNIN=false in login.tsx — the server OAuth client is not yet configured, and offering third-party login triggers Apple's guideline 4.8 requirement to also ship Sign in with Apple. Both return together in a future release.

Production Hosting on Render

The api-server runs in production on Render at <https://udecide-api.onrender.com>, deployed automatically from GitHub. This replaced the original Replit-only setup, which had no public production URL (native apps received 403s from the Replit dev domain — the root cause of the early TestFlight login failures).

3.1 How deployment works

- **Blueprint:** `render.yaml` at the repo root defines the service (type `web`, runtime `node`, rootDir `.` so the pnpm workspace installs correctly).
- **Auto-deploy:** every push to `main` triggers a fresh build and deploy (`autoDeploy: true`). Server changes ship with a `git push` — no dashboard action needed.
- **Build:** `pnpm install --no-frozen-lockfile && pnpm --filter @workspace/api-server run build` (esbuild bundles to `dist/index.mjs`).
- **Start:** `node --enable-source-maps artifacts/api-server/dist/index.mjs`. Render injects `PORT`.
- **Health check:** `GET /api/healthz → {"status":"ok"}`. Render gates deploys on it.

3.2 Render environment variables

Variable	Purpose
NODE_ENV	production
PUBLIC_ORIGIN	The service's own https origin (<code>https://udecide-api.onrender.com</code>). Added for Render — on Replit this was derived from <code>REPLIT_*</code> vars. Drives the Google OAuth redirect URI.
SESSION_SECRET	HMAC-signs the OAuth state (Render auto-generates).
GEMINI_API_KEY / GEMINI_MODEL	Fact Checker. Absent → demo responses (<code>mock:true</code>). Model default <code>gemini-3.5-flash</code> , overridable without a deploy.
CICERO_API_KEY	Live representatives. Absent → app shows per-state samples.
GOOGLE_CIVIC_API_KEY	Server /elections route (optional — the app currently calls Civic directly).
LEGACY_WS_AUTHTOKEN	Shared legacy token; absent → polls/news/questionnaires serve mock until a user signs in.
GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID / SECRET	Google sign-in (currently unset; feature hidden in app).
FACT_CHECK_LIMIT / FACT_CHECK_WINDOW_MINUTES	AI rate limit tuning (defaults 10 / 15). See Section 6.3.

3.3 Build-environment gotchas (learned the hard way)

- **No `corepack enable`** — Render builders have a read-only `/usr/bin` (EROFS). pnpm is provisioned via the root `package.json` "packageManager": "pnpm@11.5.2" field instead.
- **esbuild build script** — pnpm treats unapproved build scripts as fatal in CI (`ERR_PNPM_IGNORED_BUILDS`). esbuild is declared in `ignoredBuiltDependencies`; its Linux binary ships via the kept `@esbuild/linux-x64` optional dependency.
- **trust proxy** — `app.set("trust proxy", true)` is required behind Render's load balancer so `req.ip` resolves to the real client IP (the AI rate limiter keys anonymous callers by it).

Free-tier cold starts: the current instance spins down when idle; the first request after sleep takes ~50 seconds. For store reviews and real traffic, upgrade the service to the Starter plan (always-on) or run an uptime pinger against `/api/healthz`.

Replit relationship: the Replit workspace remains usable for development (the `.replit-artifact` config still works there), but Render is the production system of record. The app's production builds point at Render via `EXP0_PUBLIC_DOMAIN` .

Tech Stack

Layer	Technology
Mobile	Expo SDK 54 (expo ~54.0.35), React Native 0.81.5, React 19, New Architecture ON
Routing	expo-router 6 (file-based, typed routes)
Server state	TanStack React Query
Local state / persist	React Context + @react-native-async-storage/async-storage
UI libs	expo-linear-gradient, expo-blur, expo-glass-effect, expo-haptics, expo-symbols, react-native-reanimated 4, react-native-gesture-handler, react-native-keyboard-controller, react-native-webview, @expo/vector-icons
Fonts	Inter (400/500/600/700) via @expo-google-fonts/inter
Backend	Node + Express 5 + TypeScript (ESM), esbuild-bundled; pino logging; Zod validation from @workspace/api-zod
Production hosting	Render (web service, auto-deploy from GitHub main via render.yaml; Node 24 runtime)
Build / release	EAS Build (cloud) for store binaries — Node 22.14.0 pinned in the production profile; pnpm 11.5.2 via packageManager
Identifiers	Bundle ID com.udecide.app (iOS + Android); scheme udecide; Apple App ID 6783990826

Current version

Track	Version	Status
iOS — App Store	1.0 (build 8)	Approved & LIVE (July 2026)
iOS — TestFlight	1.0.0 (build 11)	Next-update candidate: live elections, AI request cap, subscription label removed
Android — Google Play	1.0.0 (versionCode 7)	Uploaded for Internal testing; Play listing/review checklist in progress
Backend	main (auto-deployed)	Live at udecide-api.onrender.com

Builds 9–11 differ from the approved build 8 as follows — 9: Google sign-in button hidden; 10: vestigial Profile "Subscription" label removed (per App Review correspondence) + Fact Checker 10-question session cap; 11: live elections via the bundled Google Civic key. Ship these as the 1.0.1 update.

Mobile App — Services & Configuration

Screens live in `artifacts/udecide/app/` (expo-router file-based; 5-tab shell + card/modal screens — see Part 1 for the user-facing inventory). All data flows through `services/`.

5.1 API client core

- `apiClient.ts` — `API_BASE = EXPO_PUBLIC_DOMAIN ? "https://<domain>/api" : "/api"`. In production builds `EXPO_PUBLIC_DOMAIN=udecide-api.onrender.com` is baked in from the EAS environment, so `API_BASE` is always absolute. `apiFetch()` attaches `AUTHTOKEN`; a 401 clears the session and routes to login.
- `session.ts` — non-React token store bridged to `AuthContext`.

5.2 Service reference

Service	Talks to	Key / auth	Fallback
authApi	api-server /auth/*	AUTHTOKEN (profile routes)	none — always live
civicApi	api-server /representatives (Cicero)	server CICERO_API_KEY	per-state samples
geminiApi	api-server /fact-check (Gemini proxy)	server GEMINI_API_KEY	server demo answers (mock:true)
pollsApi / newsApi / questionnairesApi / pagesApi / quizApi	api-server	AUTHTOKEN	server-owned
electionsApi	Google Civic v2 direct	client EXPO_PUBLIC_CIVIC_API_KEY (set — LIVE)	MOCK_ELECTIONS
congressApi	Congress.gov v3 direct	client key not set → mock	MOCK_REPRESENTATIVES/BILLS
legiscanApi	LegiScan direct	client key not set → mock	MOCK_BILLS
voterApi	none (static)	—	official gov URLs

5.3 EAS production environment (baked into store builds)

Variable	Value / state
EXPO_PUBLIC_DOMAIN	<code>udecide-api.onrender.com</code> — set (this fixed production login)
EXPO_PUBLIC_CIVIC_API_KEY	set (sensitive) — live elections since build 11. Restrict the key to the Civic Information API in Google Cloud.
EXPO_PUBLIC_CONGRESS_GOV_API_KEY	not set — federal bills use sample data
EXPO_PUBLIC_LEGISCAN_API_KEY	not set — state bills use sample data

`EXPO_PUBLIC_GEMINI_API_KEY` was **removed** (2026): the Fact Checker calls the `api-server /fact-check` proxy and the Gemini key lives only on Render — it is never bundled into the app. Manage variables with `eas env:list/create`; new values take effect on the next build.

Backend — api-server

Node + Express 5 + TypeScript (ESM, esbuild-bundled). Exists to (1) hide paid keys, (2) proxy the legacy Codelgniter backend at `https://52.45.60.139/ws` and translate its envelope into clean Zod-validated REST, (3) avoid CORS. Deployed on Render (Section 3).

6.1 Routes (all under /api)

- **auth.ts** — POST /auth/login, /auth/signup, /auth/profile, DELETE /auth/account, POST /auth/profile/photo (multipart, 8 MB cap) → legacy /user_login, /user_sign_up, /edit_profile, /delete_account.
- **googleOAuth.ts** — GET /auth/google/start & /callback, POST /auth/google/exchange & /register (server-verified; dormant while the feature is hidden).
- **representatives.ts** — GET /representatives → Cicero; {live, officials}; 502 on upstream failure.
- **elections.ts** — GET /elections, /elections/voter-info → Google Civic v2.
- **factCheck.ts** — POST /fact-check → Gemini (server key, nonpartisan system prompt, per-user rate limit — Section 6.3). Returns {text, mock}.
- **polls.ts / news.ts / civics.ts / pages.ts / home.ts / health.ts** — polls (live-or-mock), RSS news with SSRF guard, quiz/questionnaires/terminology/parties, legacy static pages, healthz.

6.2 Auth flows

Email/password: proxied to the legacy service; failures map to 401/400 with friendly messages. **Google OAuth:** full server-mediated flow (HMAC state, code exchange with the server-side secret, verified email required, one-time exchange codes) — implemented and tested, awaiting OAuth client configuration + Sign in with Apple before re-enabling in the app.

6.3 AI rate limiting (added July 2026)

- **Client:** the Fact Checker screen caps at **10 questions per session** (input disables with an explanatory banner; a new session starts when the screen is reopened).
- **Server backstop:** /fact-check enforces **10 requests per 15-minute sliding window per user**, keyed by SHA-256-hashed AUTHTOKEN (client IP fallback via trust proxy). Over-limit → HTTP 429 with a friendly message the chat UI surfaces. Verified live in production (requests 11+ receive 429 on both keying paths).
- Tunable on Render via FACT_CHECK_LIMIT / FACT_CHECK_WINDOW_MINUTES — no deploy needed.

6.4 External API inventory

API	Provides	Key location
Legacy UDecide WS (52.45.60.139/WS)	Auth, profile, polls, questionnaires, quiz, pages, news feed URL	server + per-user AUTHTOKEN
Cicero	All-levels officials by address	server CICERO_API_KEY
Google Civic v2	Elections + voter info	client EXPO_PUBLIC_CIVIC_API_KEY (live); server GOOGLE_CIVIC_API_KEY (optional)
Congress.gov v3 / LegiScan	Federal / state bills	client EXPO_PUBLIC_* (not yet set → mock)
Google Gemini	Fact-checker chat	server GEMINI_API_KEY (moved server-side 2026)
Google OAuth 2.0	Sign in with Google (disabled in 1.0)	server GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID/SECRET + SESSION_SECRET

Build, Release & Store Status

7.1 The release pipeline (EAS)

EAS Build is the single store pipeline; production builds load the EAS environment (Section 5.3), so binaries always point at the Render backend. EAS project: `@udecide-apps-organization/udecide`. iOS submission is fully automated via an App Store Connect API key (`ascAppId 6783990826`, team `DG74FTMU5Y`) configured in `artifacts/udecide/eas.json`.

```
# from artifacts/udecide/
eas build --platform all --profile production      # cloud build, env auto-loaded
eas submit --platform ios --profile production --latest # → TestFlight / App Store Connect
# Android: download the .aab from the build page and upload in Play Console
#           (or configure a Google service-account JSON for eas submit -p android)
```

Node/pnpm pinning: the root `package.json` pins `pnpm@11.5.2` (required for Render). `pnpm 11` needs `Node ≥ 22.13`, but EAS builders default to `Node 20` — so `"node": "22.14.0"` is pinned in the `eas.json` production profile. Do not remove either pin; removing one breaks the other platform's build.

7.2 Store status (July 2026)

Item	Status
iOS App Store	v1.0 (build 8) approved and live. Listing complete: screenshots, description, keywords, support URL (www.udecideapp.com), privacy policy (udecideapp.com/?page_id=3), age rating 17+/18+.
App Review history	Build 4 rejected (launch crash — OAuth URL bug + experimental React Compiler; both fixed). Guideline 3.1.1 subscription questions answered ("app is entirely free"); the vestigial Profile subscription label is removed as of build 10.
iOS 1.0.1 candidate	Build 11 in TestFlight (live elections, AI cap, label removal). Bump the version string and submit when ready.
Google Play	App record created; <code>vc7</code> .aab delivered for Internal-testing upload. Remaining: demo account in App access, Data Safety + deletion-request URL, content rating, target audience, listing assets (all prepared in <code>~/Udecide_Assets/play/</code> incl. <code>PLAY_CONSOLE_GUIDE.md</code>), then Production review. Personal accounts created after Nov 2023 require a 12-tester × 14-day closed test first.
Store assets	<code>~/Udecide_Assets/</code> — iOS screenshots (1284×2778), Play screenshots (1080×1920), feature graphic, icons, descriptions, delete-account page copy.

Known Issues & Gotchas — Read This First

1. **Render free-tier cold starts.** ~50 s to wake after idle; first app request may time out. Upgrade to Starter (always-on) or ping `/api/healthz`. This is the most user-visible operational issue.
2. **Congress.gov & LegiScan keys not set.** Federal and state bill tabs silently serve sample data in production. Add the two `EXPO_PUBLIC_*` keys in the EAS environment and rebuild for live data.
3. **Google sign-in is hidden, not removed.** Flip `SHOW_GOOGLE_SIGNIN` in `login.tsx` only after (a) `GOOGLE_CLIENT_ID/SECRET + PUBLIC_ORIGIN` are set on Render, (b) the redirect URI `https://udecide-api.onrender.com/api/auth/google/callback` is registered in Google Cloud, and (c) Sign in with Apple is implemented (App Store guideline 4.8).
4. **Concurrent file churn.** A background Replit agent also commits to this repo (it once re-added an unused `RECORD_AUDIO` permission). Always `git fetch /rebase` before pushing, and review `git diff` before each build.
5. **Legacy backend uses a self-signed certificate.** `https://52.45.60.139/WS` is encrypted but not CA-authenticated (`NODE_TLS_REJECT_UNAUTHORIZED=0` on the api-server). The app must never call it directly.
6. **Do not delete the reviewer demo account.** Both stores' reviewers use the demo credentials registered in App Review Information / Play App access.
7. **Monorepo decoys.** `mobile/` and the root `eas.json` are not the product; install from the repo root; the `minimumReleaseAge` supply-chain guard stays on.
8. **AI cost control.** The Fact Checker is capped client- and server-side (Section 6.3); if Gemini quota issues appear, lower `FACT_CHECK_LIMIT` on Render before touching code.

Getting started (new developer)

1. `pnpm install` at the repo root.
2. App: `pnpm --filter @workspace/udecide run dev` from `artifacts/udecide` (Expo dev server).
3. Backend: `pnpm --filter @workspace/api-server run dev` (needs PORT; Section 3.2 secrets for live features) — or just use the production Render API.
4. Typecheck everything: `pnpm run typecheck` at the root.
5. Where things live: screens → `artifacts/udecide/app/`; data → `artifacts/udecide/services/`; theming → `constants/colors.ts`; backend routes → `artifacts/api-server/src/routes/`; deploy → `render.yaml`.
6. Ship: build with EAS (Section 7.1), verify in TestFlight/Internal testing, then submit.